CONCLUSION

It is important for all British political parties to be intolerant of Holocaust inversion. Equating Israel with Nazi Germany trivialises the Holocaust and amounts to what Deborah Lipstadt has called "soft-core denial."[54] It also creates a climate in which British Jews feel demoralised at best, and suffer fear and intimidation at worst. Politicians are influential and they have a duty to use language responsibly. While it is legitimate for politicians to make considered criticisms of Israel and the Palestinians, it is not legitimate for them to defame Israel by equating her with Nazi Germany or to misuse the Holocaust to morally indict Jews. The fact that the Liberal Democrat Party did not act strongly enough in the case of David Ward is a matter of concern. His statement should have been treated as antisemitism, and he should have been disciplined accordingly.

NOTES

1. Anthony Julius, *Trials of the Diaspora: A History of Anti-Semitism in England* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2010), 450–55.

2. Manfred Gerstenfeld, "Holocaust Inversion: The Portraying of Israelis and Jews as Nazis," *Jerusalem Center for Public Affairs*, no. 55, 1 Apr. 2007. *Report of the All-Party Parliamentary Inquiry into Antisemitism 2006*, p. 34, para 169, http://www.antisemitism.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/All-Party-Parliamentary-Inquiry-into-Antisemitism REPORT.pdf (accessed 24 Apr. 2014).

3. Michael Gove, "We need action—now more than ever," *Jewish Chronicle*, 12 Sept. 2014, 52. For an overview of the reasons for the use of Holocaust inversion as a means to criticise Israel, see Lesley Klaff, "Political and Legal Judgment: Misuses of the Holocaust in the UK," *International Journal of the Social Research Foundation* 1 (2) (July–Dec. 2013): 1, 3–9; and for a theoretical explanation of the reasons for Holocaust inversion, see David Seymour, "From Auschwitz to Gaza: Ethics for the Want of Law" *Journal of Global Ethics* 6 (2) (2010): 205.

4. Winston Pickett, "Lenin's legacy—why Jews have been betrayed by the radical Left," J*ewish Chronicle*, 29 June 2012, http://www.thejc.com/lifestyle-features/ 69409/lenins-legacy-why-Jews-have-been-betrayed-radical-left (accessed 23 Apr. 2014). This refutes the received view that Britain "gave" the Jews Israel out of some sort of Holocaust "guilt."

5. Manfred Gerstenfeld, "Antisemitism Embedded in British Culture: An Interview with Robert Solomon Wistrich," *Post-Holocaust and Anti-Semitism* 70 (1 July 2008).

6. Robert S. Wistrich, "Anti-Semitism in Britain has gone main stream," *Cruel Britannia: Azureonline*, http://azure.org.il/include/print.php?id=173 (accessed 23 Apr. 2014).

7. Manfred Gerstenfeld, "Antisemitism Embedded."

8. Robert S. Wistrich, *A Lethal Obsession: Antisemitism from Antiquity to the Global Jihad* (New York: Random House, 2010), 377–80.

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,